Cloudflare Email Routing Setup

Route catch all email to a Cloudflare Worker

Enable Email Routing for your domain, send messages that do not match a specific address rule to a Worker, and verify delivery. Use your own domain and deployed Worker wherever example.com and demo-worker appear.

Before you begin

Have a domain using Cloudflare DNS, access to its Email Routing and DNS settings, and a deployed Worker with an email handler. If the Worker forwards mail, add the receiving mailbox under Destination addresses and verify it using Cloudflare's email. [1, 3]

Existing mail service: Changing MX records changes where incoming mail is delivered. Plan the change with the current mail provider before activating Email Routing. [2]

Step 1 Open Email Routing

Sign in to the Cloudflare dashboard and select the correct account. Go to Compute > Email Service > Email Routing, then click Onboard Domain. [1]

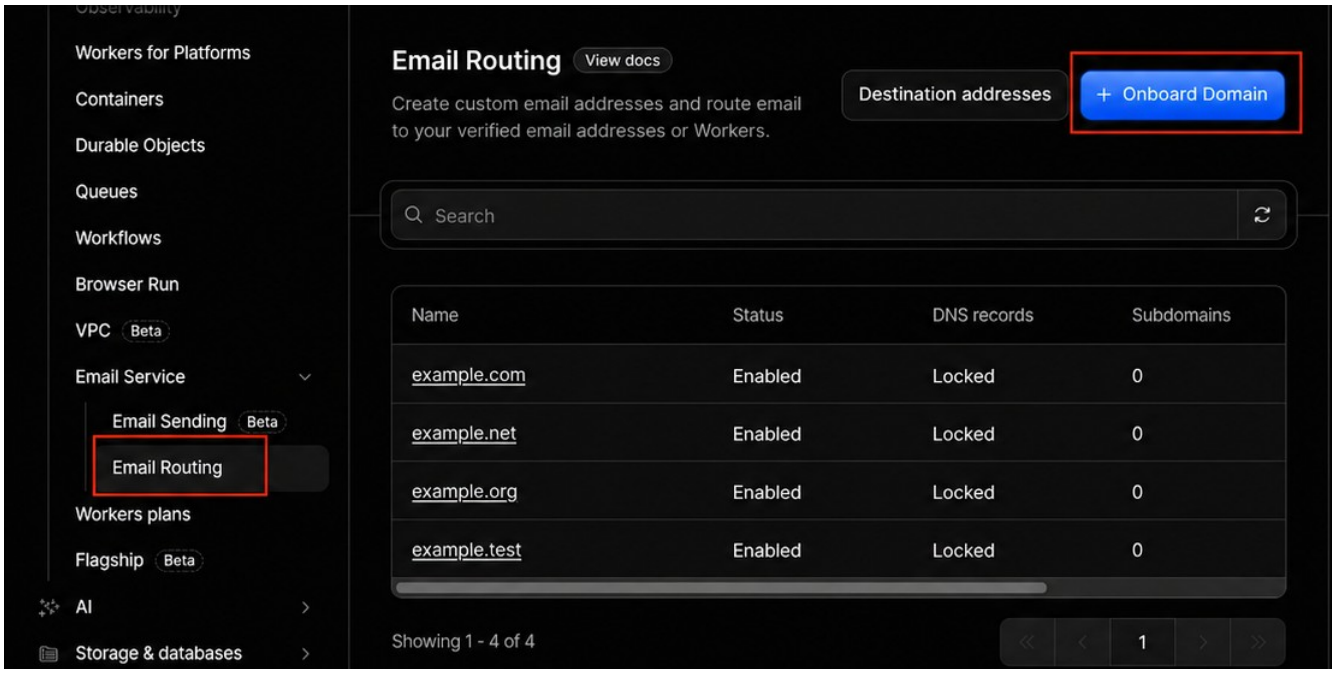


Figure 1 Open Email Routing and start domain onboarding

Step 2 Select your domain

Choose your domain in the Zone dropdown, then click Continue.

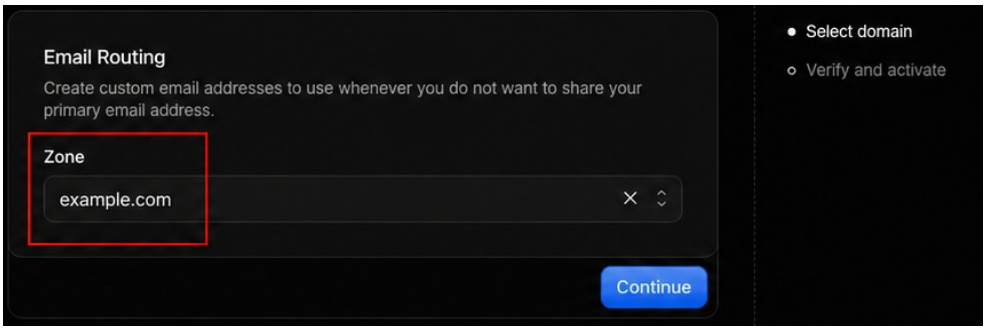


Figure 2 Select the domain to configure

Step 3 Review DNS records and activate

Review the MX and TXT records shown by Cloudflare. MX records direct incoming mail to Cloudflare; the TXT records configure SPF and DKIM. Scroll through the full list, then click Activate. [2]

Use the values generated for your own domain. The screenshot shows part of the record list. Resolve any record conflicts first; keep one SPF record with the required authorizations. [2]

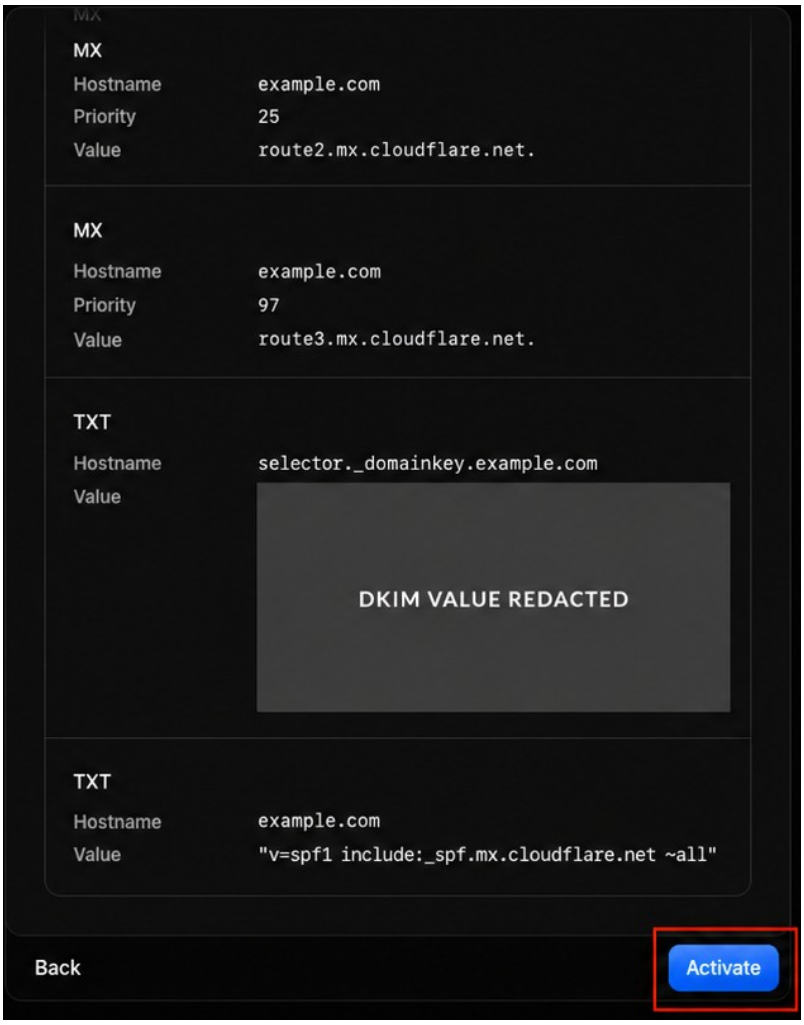


Figure 3 Review the proposed records and click Activate

Expected result: Domain onboarding completes. DNS changes may take time to propagate; wait and recheck the domain status if activation is still pending. [1]

Some dashboard versions finish onboarding with Done. Complete the confirmation shown in your dashboard. [1]

Step 4 Open the configured domain

Return to the Email Routing domain list. Find the domain you just configured, confirm that its Status is Enabled, and click its name. A Locked DNS records label means Cloudflare is managing those records. [2]

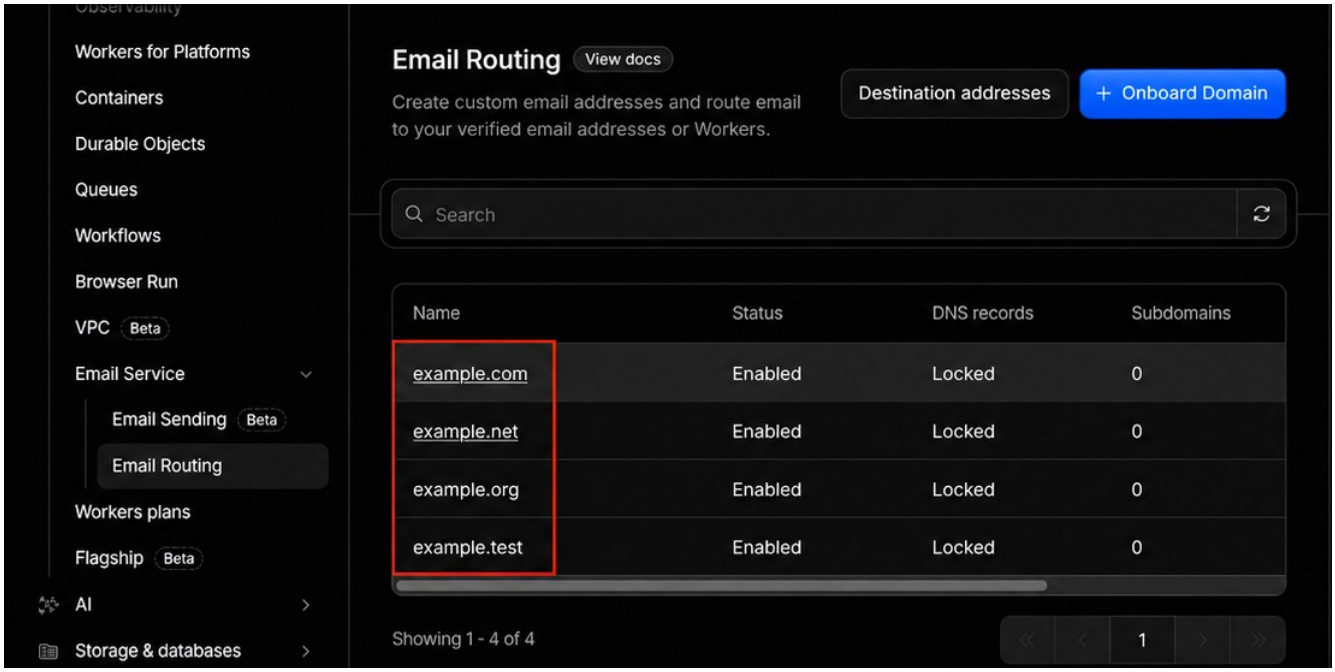


Figure 4 Open the domain whose routing settings you want to change

Step 5 Edit the catch all rule

Open the Routing rules tab. In the Catch-all row, click the three-dot menu on the right and select Edit.

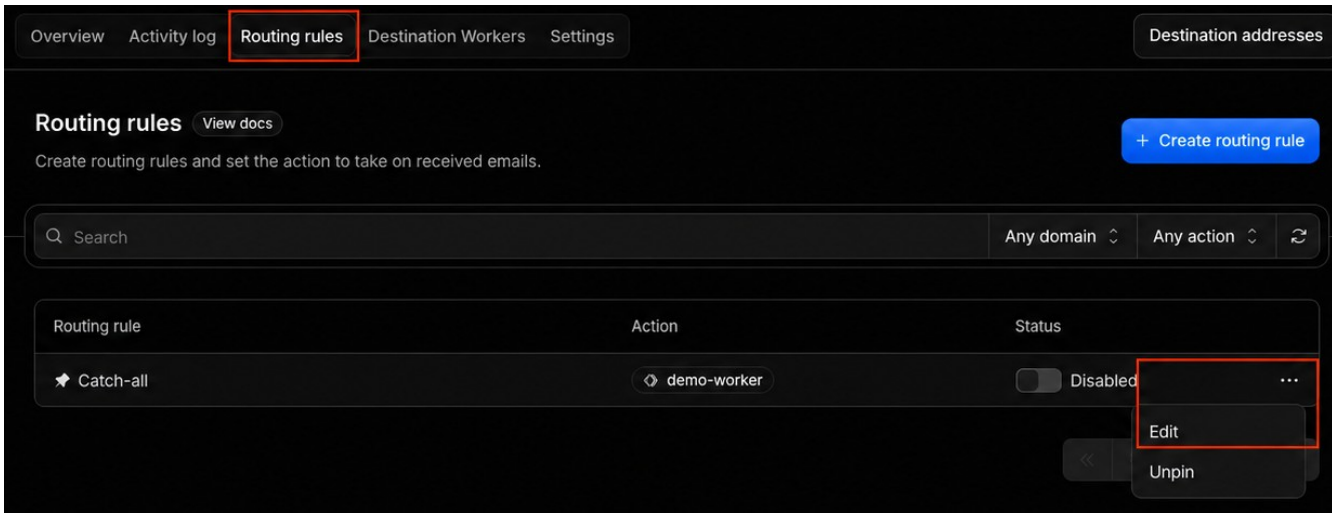


Figure 5 Open Routing rules and edit Catch-all

The catch-all rule handles email addresses in this domain that are not handled by a more specific rule. It can also receive messages sent to misspelled or unexpected addresses. [3]

Step 6 Choose the destination Worker

In Edit catch-all rule, set Action to Send to a Worker. In Destination, select your deployed email Worker, then click Save. The example Worker is named demo-worker.

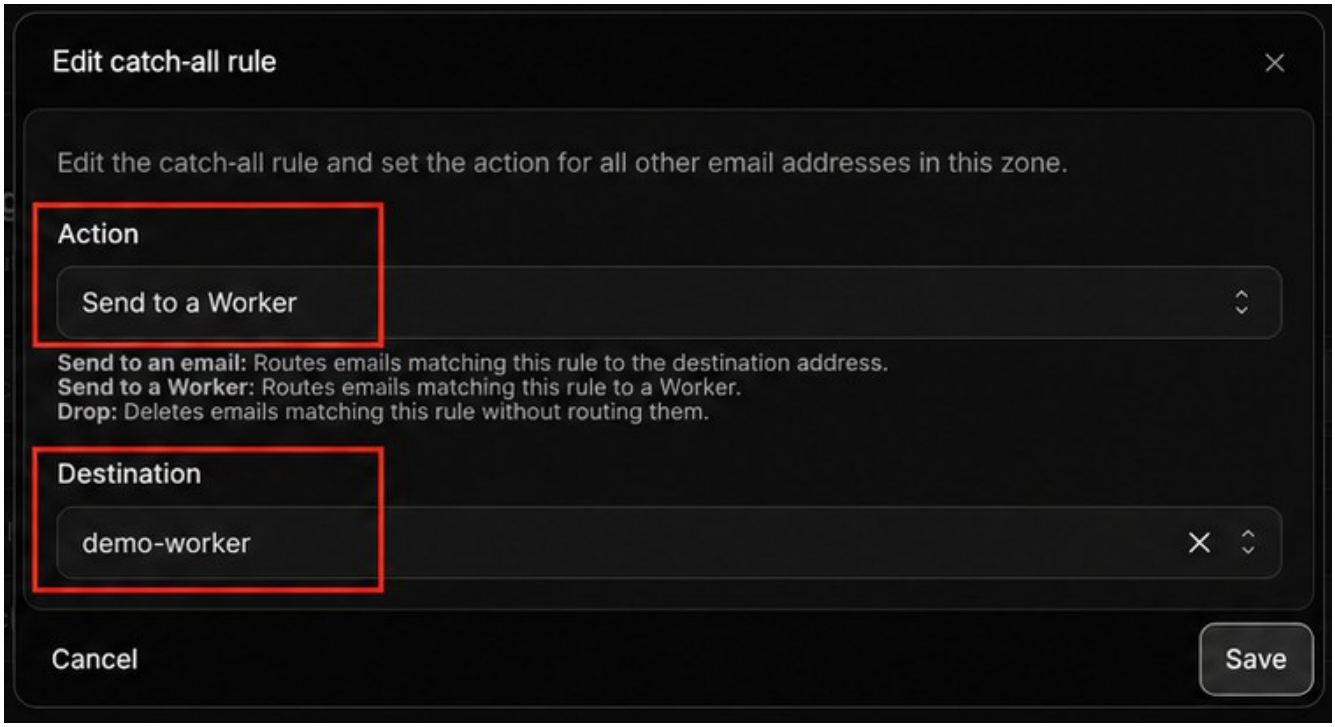


Figure 6 Choose Send to a Worker and save the destination

Confirm the Worker is ready

The Worker must contain an email handler that performs the processing you need. Selecting a destination connects the rule to that Worker; the Worker code determines whether the message is forwarded, rejected, or otherwise processed. [1, 3]

- Confirm that the selected Worker is deployed in the correct account and appears in the Destination dropdown.
- If forwarding is intended, confirm the receiving mailbox is a verified destination address in Cloudflare and that the Worker uses that address. [1, 3]

If the Worker is missing from the list, check its deployment and email handler before proceeding.

For direct forwarding to a mailbox

If you do not need Worker processing, choose Send to an email instead and select a verified destination address. Click Save, then enable the catch-all rule as described in Step 7. [3]

Step 7 Enable the catch all rule

Back on Routing rules, turn on the Status toggle for Catch-all. Confirm that it shows Active or the equivalent enabled state. Saving the destination and enabling the rule are separate checks. [3]

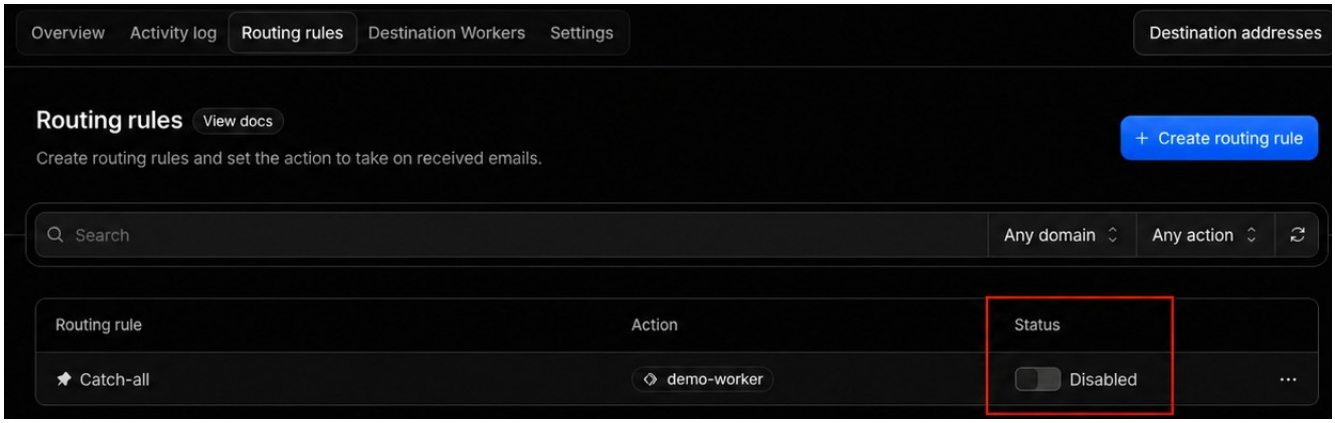


Figure 7 The switch is still OFF here Turn it on to activate the rule

The screenshot shows Disabled, which is the state before this step is complete. The domain can be Enabled while the catch-all rule is still Disabled.

Step 8 Test incoming mail

Send a test message from an external email account to a new address at your domain, such as routing-test@example.com. Choose an address with no separate routing rule so the test exercises Catch-all. [1, 3]

Check the Worker execution logs or your application's expected result. If the Worker forwards messages, confirm receipt in the destination inbox and check spam if needed. Use a sender different from the forwarding destination. [1]

Setup is complete when the domain is enabled, the catch-all rule is active, the intended Worker is selected, and a test message produces the expected result.

If the test fails

No incoming message: Recheck the domain's MX records, DNS propagation and catch-all status. Worker runs but no delivery: Inspect its logs and forwarding logic, verify the destination mailbox, and check spam. Wrong rule runs: Use a test address without a specific address rule.

Official Cloudflare references

[1] Route emails

[2] Domain configuration

[3] Email routing rules and addresses